

The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples

Any good budget has to be a plan created *by* two people *for* two people, not a plan created by one person for two people. You must pray about it together, commit it to God together, and have a peace about it together. And it has to be fair for both. Whatever spending money the husband gets, the wife gets the same amount (and vice versa). If she gets \$50 a month for clothes, he gets \$50 a month for clothes. If he gets \$50 a month for bass boats, she gets \$50 a month for whatever she wants.

It must be a plan that is fair for both husband and wife because a good marriage is a partnership. If you can learn that in your marriage, you'll have the best communications tool available. If you don't, you'll have the biggest arguments imaginable. This is typically what's happening in America today.

SUMMARY

What then is a budget? It is simply a plan to manage the money in your home. There is nothing magical about a budget, however, and it will not work by itself. You must put it into practice.

Every area of your spending must be reviewed to determine if you are spending the correct amount. If you're not, you must decide how you can adjust. A budget, if used properly, should help to determine what kind of a home you can afford, what kind of a car you can drive, how much insurance you should have, even what kind of clothes you wear.

Your budget should be a reflection of you. It should be a plan to bring peace, not conflict, into your home. If, as husband and wife, you find that you cannot agree on a budget by yourselves, consult a pastor or a counselor in Christian financial service. Ask him to help you develop a budget and use him as a sounding board. "Without consultation, plans are frustrated, but with many counselors they succeed" (Proverbs 15:22).

WHO NEEDS TO BUDGET?

Obviously, those who are in debt need to budget. Why? Because they're spending more than they make. The budget is